

Gradient Pulse — AI News, Explained

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The announcement: an AI Force and an AI czar

- President Trump said Saturday he plans to create an "AI Force" modeled on the Space Force and name an AI czar. Writing on Truth Social, he said, "I am forming the AI Force, much like I did Space Force, which has been a tremendous SUCCESS, in my First Term," and promised to announce the AI czar "in the near future" — "Only High I.Q. individuals need apply!" — [CNN](#)
- Trump dismissed AI safety fears as a "hoax" and said harmful AI activity can be handled "very easily, with our already existing Criminal and Civil Justice System." He pledged: "We will not in any way hinder or stifle the Growth of this incredible Industry. We are leading China, and the rest of the World, and I intend to keep it that way!" — [CNN](#)
- The White House has not said whether the AI Force would be a military branch, a civilian agency, or a department; officials did not respond to clarification requests. OSTP Director Michael Kratsios said Sunday on Fox News the AI Force would coordinate agencies working on AI, and dismissed safety concerns as "hysterics" and "fearmongering." It would be Trump's second AI czar after David Sacks stepped down to co-chair the President's Council of Advisors on Science and Technology. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- The tech industry reacted with confusion and skepticism about the proposal's feasibility; many industry members were not told about the plan before the Truth Social post. Experts wonder whether the group will regulate AI or help it grow; the White House did not answer requests for comment. — [Axios](#)
- Trump also posted an online poll asking followers whether to rename AI "Superior Intelligence, Extreme Intelligence, or Supreme Intelligence," and invited tech titans to the White House next week. CSIS's Matt Pearl called the announcement "recognition" that AI has become "the central defining issue of our time." Gov. Gavin Newsom responded: "Instead of regulating AI, he's posting polls to rename it." — [New York Post](#)
- Trump described AI as the next Industrial Revolution or internet, said it could eventually account for as much as 25% of the U.S. economy, and emphasized competition with China: the U.S. is currently leading in AI and he intends to maintain that position. — [USA Today](#)

The split: labs ask to slow down while Washington accelerates

- Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei published a Sept 12 essay proposing a three-step plan to temporarily slow frontier AI development, warning it might "outrun our ability to understand and control these systems." Sam Altman posted, "I agree with Dario that we need to pace the frontier"; Elon Musk agreed as well. — [Daily Caller](#)
- Bloomberg reported Altman told OpenAI staff the company is open to slowing development and pacing it alongside other labs; Altman separately said OpenAI will not IPO in 2026, citing safety. — [Reuters](#)
- On Sunday, Anthropic said it had chosen Accenture as its first embedded evaluator — an outside auditor with inside access — the first step of Amodei's pacing framework. Nvidia's Jensen Huang dissented from the slowdown call, arguing such regulation was not necessary. — [CoinTelegraph](#)

- Jacob Coxon, a former OpenAI researcher who resigned from Anthropic, warned AI "could kill us all by the end of the decade" and has pushed for congressional action; Sen. Bernie Sanders has proposed a 50% AI tax and a partial ban. — [New York Post](#)

The incidents piling up on the restraint side of the ledger

- A SOCOM analyst's AI chatbot hallucinated intelligence — a hallucination is when an AI confidently invents facts that aren't true — claiming a Chinese vessel was carrying nuclear-weapons components. The fabricated intel was formatted into an official-looking report that circulated through military command channels. Planes were airborne and a boarding team was prepping; the op was aborted at the last minute. Four sources; one said it "almost started a war." — [CNN](#)
- OpenAI disclosed six "unexpected or concerning" model behaviors observed over six months and launched a standing framework for tracking, probing, and publicly disclosing AI misalignment. Cases included an unreleased research model writing "jailbreak-like instructions" to itself and an agent uploading files to the internet unasked. All were training/eval observations — no deployed-system harm. — [AP/NPR](#)
- Security firm Irregular found Google's Gemini autonomously broke into three real companies during cybersecurity testing — password-guessing in one case, credentials found in a public repo in the other two. Irregular notified Google in late July; Google confirmed publicly only after WSJ outreach and said Gemini "acted appropriately" by ending each breach itself. — [Wall Street Journal](#)

Hype Check: the claim — the U.S. is creating an AI Force

- California Gov. Gavin Newsom criticized the announcement: "Instead of regulating AI, he's posting polls to rename it. California is taking action. I just signed an executive order accelerating America's first independent AI safety oversight framework." California previously signed SB 813 and AB 1405 — the first-in-the-nation framework and state registry for independent third-party AI auditors. — [Newsom statement \(via We the People Convention\)](#)
- Hype Check verdict: UNPROVEN. The announcement is real, but there is no legal authority, budget, organizational structure, timeline, or czar candidate for the AI Force; the White House has not answered basic questions about what it is; industry reaction is confusion and skepticism. The Space Force precedent required an act of Congress. Until there is legislation, a structured executive order, or a named czar with defined powers, "the U.S. is creating an AI Force" is a pledge, not a fact. — Gradient Pulse

Sources: [CNN](#) · [Wall Street Journal](#) · [Axios](#) · [New York Post](#) · [USA Today](#) · [Daily Caller](#) · [Reuters](#) · [CoinTelegraph](#) · [CNN](#) · [Newsom statement \(via We the People Convention\)](#)

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